

KARTHIKEYAN K

Cyber Security Analyst | Penetration Tester | Application Security

Fresher | Actively Seeking Entry-Level Opportunities in Application Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

MCA graduate with hands-on experience in Web Application Penetration Testing, API Security Testing, Vulnerability Assessment (VAPT), and Security Research. Experienced in OWASP Top 10 assessments, Bug Bounty, Responsible Disclosure, and Python-based security automation. Proficient with Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit, and Kali Linux. Seeking an entry-level Cyber Security, Application Security, or Penetration Testing role.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (MCA)

2024 – 2026

P.S.N.A College of Engineering and Technology | CGPA: 7.3/10

Bachelor of Computer Science (B. Sc.)

2020 – 2023

Vidhyasagar College of Arts and Science | CGPA: 7.0/10

CORE SKILLS

Web Application Security, API Security, OWASP Top 10, OWASP API Top 10, Authentication Testing, Authorization Testing, Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT), REST API, JWT, IDOR, SSRF, CSRF, XXE, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, TCP/IP & Networking, Linux Administration, Security Research, CVSS Scoring, CWE / CVE Classification, Security Monitoring & Incident Response Concepts, Report Writing & Documentation.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Penetration Testing: Burp Suite, Caido, OWASP ZAP, Metasploit, SQLmap, Hydra, ffuf, Netcat

Network & Monitoring: Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS, Cisco Packet Tracer

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Linux CLI

Programming & Scripting: Python

Version Control & Dev: Git, GitHub

INDEPENDENT SECURITY RESEARCH & BUG BOUNTY WORK

Self-initiated research and responsible disclosure work, not employment.

Security Researcher – NASA Vulnerability Disclosure Program

Jan 2026

- Identified and responsibly disclosed authentication and access control vulnerabilities on live NASA web applications.
- Performed comprehensive reconnaissance, endpoint analysis, and manual security testing using OWASP Top 10 methodologies.
- Findings acknowledged by NASA security. **GitHub:** github.com/karthikeyank-vapt/security-research-portfolio

OAuth Security Researcher – Managed Bug Bounty Program

Feb 2026

- Discovered OAuth open redirect vulnerability affecting authentication workflows in a live production environment.
- Analyzed authorization mechanisms and identified critical weaknesses in OAuth 2.0 implementation. Reported findings. **GitHub:** github.com/karthikeyank-vapt/oauth-security-assessment

Security Researcher – Responsible Disclosure Programs

May 2026

- Identified and disclosed information disclosure vulnerabilities across multiple web applications.
- Findings acknowledged through responsible disclosure. **GitHub:** github.com/karthikeyank-vapt/responsible-disclosure-portfolio

PLATFORMS

HackerOne, Bugcrowd, Intigriti, PortSwigger Web Security Academy, TryHackMe, NASA Vulnerability Disclosure Program.

PROJECTS

Modular Automated Information Gathering Framework for Web Security Assessment

- Developed a modular Python-based reconnaissance framework integrating subdomain enumeration, live host detection, endpoint extraction, JavaScript analysis, and sensitive file discovery.
- Reduced manual reconnaissance time through multithreading using ThreadPoolExecutor.
- Generated structured security assessment reports for discovered assets.
- **Tech Stack:** Python, ThreadPoolExecutor, Linux CLI

OWASP Lite Vulnerability Scanner

- Developed a Python-based automated scanner to detect OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities including XSS, SQL Injection, and security misconfigurations in web applications.
- **GitHub:** github.com/karthikeyank-vapt/owasp-lite-vulnerability-scanner

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified LLM Security Professional (CLLMSP) – Red Team Leaders
- Certified Network Security Practitioner (CNSP) – The SecOps Group
- SQL Injection Attacks – EC-Council
- Penetration Testing with Metasploit – LinkedIn Learning
- Security Analyst Certificate Program – Skill India (NSDC)
- Python Programming Certification – IIT Bombay
- Ethical Hacking & Pentest Mastery – Udemy

ACHIEVEMENTS

TCS HackQuest Cybersecurity Competition – Final Round Qualifier

- Qualified for the Final Round of TCS HackQuest through hands-on expertise in penetration testing, web application security, and vulnerability assessment.